

# Alignment of the Canadian Language Benchmarks to the Global Scale of English: Stage II Intermediate

November 2024

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## About the GSE

Pearson developed the Global Scale of English (GSE) to provide instructors and learners with a more detailed understanding of English language proficiency. It has been designed to build learners' confidence by revealing exactly where they are on their learning journey and setting personalised goals to help them progress.

The GSE is an ecosystem that underpins the Pearson English Journey:

- **GSE Scale:** a proficiency scale from 10 to 90.
- **GSE Learning Objectives:** descriptions of what learners can do at each level of proficiency in speaking, listening, reading, and writing.
- **Courseware:** all of Pearson's English language learning courseware is developed using the GSE Learning Objectives.
- **Assessment:** institutions can develop their own assessment materials using the GSE Learning Objectives and Assessment Frameworks or choose one of Pearson's digital assessments which report on the GSE.

The GSE is the result of many years of research with more than 6,000 teachers from over 50 countries. It serves as a standard against which English language courses and assessments worldwide can be benchmarked.

The GSE has been psychometrically aligned to the Common European Framework of Reference or CEFR (see De Jong, Mayor, & Hayes, 2016). It complements and extends the CEFR by adding an extra layer of detail to the CEFR levels and providing thousands of additional learning objectives. This extra information helps learners understand where they are now and offers a step-by-step guide to where they want to go next. Using the GSE, teachers can match a student to course materials to suit their exact level and learning goals.

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| CEFR level         | GSE Scale |
|--------------------|-----------|
| Below A1           | 10–21     |
| A1                 | 22–29     |
| A2                 | 30–35     |
| A2+ ('plus level') | 36–42     |
| B1                 | 43–50     |
| B1+ ('plus level') | 51–58     |
| B2                 | 59–66     |
| B2+ ('plus level') | 67–75     |
| C1                 | 76–84     |
| C2                 | 85–90     |

Table 1: The relationship between the GSE and the CEFR

To address the specific needs of learners studying English for different purposes, GSE Learning Objectives have been developed for five different learner audiences:

- **adult:** adults studying on a general English course
- **academic:** adults studying academic English
- **professional:** adults studying English for the workplace
- **young learner:** English language learners aged 6–14
- **pre-primary:** English language learners aged 3–5

**For more information:**

[pearson.com/languages/why-pearson/the-global-scale-of-english](https://www.pearson.com/languages/why-pearson/the-global-scale-of-english)

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## About Canadian Language Benchmarks

For the purposes of this alignment, we worked with the 2012 edition of *Canadian Language Benchmarks: English as a Second Language for Adults*. The Canadian Language Benchmarks (CLB) are written as 12 benchmarks along a continuum from basic to advanced. These 12 benchmarks are then organised into three stages, each associated with a degree of complexity and demand.

This report looks at the four benchmarks in Stage II – Intermediate Language Ability:

*“Intermediate language ability encompasses abilities that allow fuller participation in a wider variety of contexts. It is the range of abilities required to function independently in most familiar situations of daily social, educational and work-related life experience, and in some less predictable contexts. In the CLB, these are referred to as moderately demanding contexts of language use.” (CLB, p10)*

### Stage II – Intermediate Language Ability

| Benchmark and Ability Level                                             | Listening                                                                                                                               | Speaking                                                                                                                            | Reading                                                                                                                                  | Writing                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CLB 5: Initial<br>CLB 6: Developing<br>CLB 7: Adequate<br>CLB 8: Fluent | Interpreting moderately complex spoken communication in moderately demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas. | Creating moderately complex spoken communication in moderately demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas. | Interpreting moderately complex written communication in moderately demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas. | Creating moderately complex written communication in moderately demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas. |

Table 2: Stage II – Intermediate Language Ability (CLB, p11)

For each language skill, there are four broad representative competency areas: Interacting with others, Instructions, Getting things done, Sharing information.

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## Alignment Methodology and Results

Each Canadian Language Benchmark competency statement within each competency area was aligned to one or more GSE Learning Objectives. The profile of ability, sample indicators of ability and sample tasks were also consulted during the alignment. Given that the target audience for CLBs is adult learners, GSE Learning Objectives for Adults, Professionals and Academic were used.

The results of the GSE alignment show consistency with the CEFR-CLB alignment carried out by North and Piccardo in 2018.

| Stage                   | CLB level | GSE range | CEFR-CLB alignment<br>(North & Piccardo) |
|-------------------------|-----------|-----------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>I: Basic</b>         | 1         | 10-19     | <A1                                      |
|                         | 2         | 20-27     | A1                                       |
|                         | 3         | 28-34     | A1/A2                                    |
|                         | 4         | 35-41     | A2/A2+                                   |
| <b>II: Intermediate</b> | 5         | 42-46     | B1                                       |
|                         | 6         | 47-52     | B1/B1+                                   |
|                         | 7         | 53-58     | B1+                                      |
|                         | 8         | 59-66     | B2                                       |
| <b>III: Advanced</b>    | 9         | 67-72     | B2+                                      |
|                         | 10        | 73-78     | C1                                       |
|                         | 11        | 79-84     | C1                                       |
|                         | 12        | 85-90     | C2                                       |

Table 3: CLB-GSE alignment compared to CLB-CEFR

# Stage II – Benchmark 5

## Listening

| CLB Competency Area            | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                               | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                         | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others     | Understand the gist and some details in moderately complex common and predictable social exchanges (that may express interests, likes, dislikes, preferences, offers, invitations and compliments).    | Can understand the main points of a short, informal interview on a familiar topic.                                             | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can follow everyday conversation, with some repetition of particular words and phrases.                                        | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can extract key details from conversations between colleagues about familiar topics.                                           | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can recognise simple expressions of agreement and disagreement in extended discussions, if conducted in clear standard speech. | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
| II. Comprehending instructions | Understand simple to moderately complex directions and instructions for generally familiar and relevant procedures.                                                                                    | Can recognise some fixed expressions to check or clarify information.                                                          | 37        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can understand instructions delivered at normal speed and accompanied by visual support.                                       | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can identify a simple chronological sequence in a recorded narrative or dialogue.                                              | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
| III. Getting things done       | Understand the gist and some details in moderately complex communication intended to influence or persuade (such as simple advice, opinion or suggestions) in everyday personally relevant situations. | Can follow the main points in a simple audio recording aimed at a general audience.                                            | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can identify a speaker's point of view in a simple presentation or lecture aimed at a general audience.                        | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
| IV. Comprehending information  | Understand information about familiar or relevant topics.                                                                                                                                              | Can follow familiar topics if the speaker is clear and avoids idiomatic usage.                                                 | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can follow the main points of extended discussion around them if in standard speech.                                           | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                | Understand descriptive or narrative monologues or presentations related to everyday, personally relevant topics or situations.                                                                         | Can identify key details in a simple recorded dialogue or narrative.                                                           | 39        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can listen to a short narrative and predict what will happen next.                                                             | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can follow familiar topics if the speaker is clear and avoids idiomatic usage.                                                 | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can extract key factual information such as dates, numbers and quantities from a presentation.                                 | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |

# Speaking

| CLB Competency Area        | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                    | GSE Learning Objective                                                                               | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others | Participate in basic social conversations for some everyday purposes (such as expressing feelings; making, accepting or declining invitations; and engaging in small talk). | Can make an invitation including information about the time and location.                            | 37        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can give compliments, using fixed expressions.                                                       | 37        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can check or clarify information using some simple fixed expressions.                                | 41        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can use some basic interjections to express understanding, surprise, disappointment, and excitement. | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can react appropriately to good and bad news using fixed expressions.                                | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can use fixed expressions to keep a conversation going (e.g. 'I see.', 'right').                     | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can respond to an offer or suggestion, expressing enthusiasm.                                        | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can initiate, maintain and close simple, face-to-face conversations on familiar topics.              | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            | Participate in very short phone calls.                                                                                                                                      | Can make an appointment on the phone.                                                                | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can leave simple, clear and appropriately expressed work-related phone messages.                     | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can ask for changes to a hotel, restaurant, or transportation reservation on the phone.              | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can use simple appropriate language to check that information has been understood on the phone.      | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can return a phone call, explaining who is calling and the reason for the call.                      | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can arrange a delivery time on the phone.                                                            | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can buy a ticket for an event on the phone.                                                          | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
| II. Giving instructions    | Give instructions and directions for everyday activities and processes.                                                                                                     | Can give the order of a work-related process using simple language (eg. first, second, then).        | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can ask for, follow and give detailed directions.                                                    | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can describe how often a work-related task should be completed.                                      | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             | Can explain the rules of a familiar game or sport using simple language.                             | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |

| CLB Competency Area      | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                   | GSE Learning Objective                                                                       | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| III. Getting things done | Give and respond to informal requests, permission, suggestions and advice.                                                                 | Can make and respond to suggestions.                                                         | 41        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can respond to an offer or suggestion, expressing enthusiasm.                                | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can deal with common situations when making travel arrangements or travelling.               | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can give an opinion when asked directly, provided they can ask for repetition.               | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can make simple recommendations for a course of action in familiar everyday situations.      | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can give brief reasons and explanations, using simple language.                              | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can use simple, fixed expressions to make offers in a simple business transaction.           | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can suggest possible solutions to a problem using simple language.                           | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
| IV. Sharing information  | Ask for and give information related to routine daily activities in one-on-one interactions.                                               | Can give a short, basic description of events and activities.                                | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can convey simple relevant information emphasising the most important point.                 | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can give or seek personal views and opinions in discussing topics of interest.               | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          | Agree, disagree and give opinions in small group discussions or meetings.                                                                  | Can express opinions using simple language.                                                  | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can express belief, opinion, agreement and disagreement politely.                            | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          | Give presentations about sequences of events; incidents in the past, present or future; or to describe scenes, pictures or daily routines. | Can describe very basic events in the past using simple linking words (e.g. 'then', 'next'). | 38        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can end a presentation by thanking the group for their time and attention.                   | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can describe future plans and intentions using fixed expressions.                            | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can give a short talk about a familiar topic, with visual support.                           | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can narrate a story.                                                                         | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can use basic discourse markers to structure a short presentation.                           | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can convey simple information of immediate relevance and emphasise the main point.           | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                            | Can describe events, real or imagined.                                                       | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |

# Reading

| CLB Competency Area            | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                       | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                     | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others     | Understand simple to moderately complex personal and public social messages (such as those conveying compliments, invitations, likes, dislikes and preferences) related to a familiar context. | Can understand simple informal written advice on a work-related situation.                                 | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can understand standard emails on work-related topics.                                                     | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can distinguish between fact and opinion presented in simple texts on familiar topics.                     | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
| II. Comprehending instructions | Understand simple to moderately complex, step-by-step instructions and instructional texts for multistep procedures related to everyday situations.                                            | Can understand simple technical information (e.g. instructions for everyday equipment).                    | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can understand written instructions for taking medication.                                                 | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can understand clearly written, straightforward instructions on how to use a piece of equipment.           | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
| III. Getting things done       | Locate and use 1 or 2 pieces of information from moderately complex formatted texts (such as standard maps, charts, forms, tables, schedules, directories or website navigation menus).        | Can understand a simple form asking for medical information                                                | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can make basic inferences or predictions about text content from headings, titles or headlines.            | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can find and understand information in advertisements for sporting or cultural events.                     | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can generally understand straightforward factual texts on familiar topics.                                 | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                | Get information from simple to moderately complex business or service texts (such as public announcements, brochures, notices, business letters and flyers).                                   | Can skim a short text to identify its main purpose.                                                        | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can understand information in advertisements for jobs and services.                                        | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can find and understand information in advertisements for sporting or cultural events.                     | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can understand information in advertisements for jobs and services.                                        | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can scan a resume/CV for key information.                                                                  | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                | Can understand basic types of standard letters and emails on familiar topics (e.g. enquiries, complaints). | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |

| CLB Competency Area           | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                           | GSE Learning Objective                                                                           | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| IV. Comprehending information | Understand simple to moderately complex descriptive or narrative texts on familiar topics.                         | Can identify similarities and differences between two short texts.                               | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can skim a simple text to identify key concepts.                                                 | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can identify key subject vocabulary in written descriptions.                                     | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               | Interpret information contained in formatted texts (such as diagrams, tables, graphs or website navigation menus). | Can understand the main information from simple diagrams (e.g. graphs, bar charts).              | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can recognise the departments and their functions presented in a company's organisational chart. | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can derive the probable meaning of simple unknown words from short, familiar contexts.           | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               | Access and locate basic information from reference sources.                                                        | Can scan short texts to locate specific information.                                             | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can search the internet for specific everyday or work-related information.                       | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |

# Writing

| CLB Competency Area         | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                  | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                                                                                        | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others  | Convey personal messages in short, formal and informal correspondence for a range of everyday social purposes (such as expressing or responding to invitations and feelings, or providing quick updates). | Can write a basic informal email/letter of invitation with simple, key details.                                                                                                               | 41        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write a basic email/letter accepting or declining an invitation.                                                                                                                          | 41        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can respond to simple work-related messages from colleagues on professional social networks.                                                                                                  | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can give basic advice in writing using simple language.                                                                                                                                       | 43        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write a simple email declining a work-related invitation.                                                                                                                                 | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write an email/letter congratulating someone on something.                                                                                                                                | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write a short reply to a message requiring an immediate response.                                                                                                                         | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write simple informal emails/letters and online postings giving news or opinions.                                                                                                         | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
| II. Reproducing information | Reduce short, factual, oral discourse (such as live or recorded phone messages or pre-recorded public information lines) to notes or messages.                                                            | Can take simple notes on key points made during a meeting on a familiar work-related topic.                                                                                                   | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             | Reduce a page of information to a list of important details.                                                                                                                                              | Can relay in writing specific information contained in short simple informational texts, provided the texts concern concrete, familiar subjects and are composed in simple everyday language. | 40        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write basic work-related instructions as a list or bullet points.                                                                                                                         | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write a notice that clearly conveys information.                                                                                                                                          | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
| III. Getting things done    | Write short business or service correspondence for routine personal needs.                                                                                                                                | Can write a simple email requesting work-related information.                                                                                                                                 | 42        | A2+ (36–42) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write a short online profile.                                                                                                                                                             | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write work-related correspondence on familiar topics using a limited range of grammar and expressions.                                                                                    | 44        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write a resume/CV with basic information about educational and work history.                                                                                                              | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can write simple instructions on how to use a device or product, given a model.                                                                                                               | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |

| CLB Competency Area                 | CLB Competency Statement                                                                               | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                 | GSE level | CEFR level |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|
| III. Getting things done<br>(cont.) | Write short business or service correspondence for routine personal needs.<br>(cont.)                  | Can write a basic formal email/letter requesting information.                                          | 46        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write a paragraph giving information about a job or interest.                                      | 46        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write descriptions of familiar job roles and responsibilities.                                     | 47        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write a simple email of introduction in a professional context.                                    | 47        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write a simple email, giving details of work-related events or plans.                              | 47        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write a simple letter to explain a change (e.g. a price increase).                                 | 47        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     | Complete forms requiring detailed personal information.                                                | Can complete simple forms setting objectives and goals in their job role.                              | 44        | B1 (43–50) |
| IV. Sharing information             | Write a paragraph to relate a familiar sequence of events, description of a person, object or routine. | Can make simple, logical paragraph breaks in a longer text.                                            | 45        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write a story with a simple linear sequence.                                                       | 45        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write a basic paragraph containing a topic sentence and related details, if provided with a model. | 45        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can give a simple reason for an action in an informational text, given a model.                        | 45        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write simple informal emails/letters and online postings giving news or opinions.                  | 46        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write the concluding sentence or sentences of a basic paragraph, given a model.                    | 46        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write a description of a future event or activity.                                                 | 46        | B1 (43–50) |
|                                     |                                                                                                        | Can write descriptions of real or imaginary people.                                                    | 47        | B1 (43–50) |

## Stage II – Benchmark 6

### Listening

| CLB Competency Area            | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                              | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                                        | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others     | Understand common social exchanges (such as openings and closings, making and cancelling of appointments, apologies, regrets, excuses, and problems in reception and communication).  | Can understand the main points of narratives and conversations about familiar topics (e.g. work, leisure) delivered in clear standard speech. | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can recognise emphasis through intonation and stress, if guided by questions.                                                                 | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can recognise a speaker's feelings or attitudes.                                                                                              | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can follow an everyday conversation or informal interview on common topics.                                                                   | 51        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can understand a range of formal and informal excuses.                                                                                        | 54        | B1+ (51–58) |
| II. Comprehending instructions | Understand moderately complex directions and instructions for technical or non-technical tasks.                                                                                       | Can follow the main points of short talks on familiar topics if delivered in clear standard speech.                                           | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can understand simple technical instructions for everyday equipment.                                                                          | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can follow recorded instructions and information given on a phone-delivered service.                                                          | 51        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can recognise that a speaker is clarifying points they have made in a simple presentation or lecture.                                         | 54        | B1+ (51–58) |
| III. Getting things done       | Understand moderately complex communication intended to influence or persuade (such as suggestions, advice, encouragements and requests) in everyday, personally relevant situations. | Can extract key factual information from a phone conversation on a familiar topic.                                                            | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can understand advice on a work-related situation.                                                                                            | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can identify the main action points in a work-related meeting conducted in clear, standard speech.                                            | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can infer speakers' opinions in conversations on familiar everyday topics.                                                                    | 51        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                       | Can understand conversations about rules or regulations related to the workplace.                                                             | 51        | B1+ (51–58) |

# Listening

| CLB Competency Area           | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                   | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                   | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| IV. Comprehending information | Understand short group interactions and discussions on familiar topics.                                    | Can generally follow changes of topic in discussions related to their field if conducted slowly and clearly.             | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               | Understand descriptive or narrative monologues or presentations on generally familiar and relevant topics. | Can extract the key details from a presentation if delivered slowly and clearly.                                         | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                            | Can identify specific information in a simple presentation or lecture aimed at a general audience.                       | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                            | Can identify the main point of TV news items reporting events, accidents, etc. where the visual supports the commentary. | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                            | Can infer opinions in a simple presentation or lecture, if guided by questions.                                          | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                            | Can follow the linear structure of a short formal talk.                                                                  | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                            | Can distinguish between main ideas and supporting details in familiar, standard texts.                                   | 51        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                               |                                                                                                            | Can distinguish between advantages and disadvantages in a simple presentation or lecture.                                | 52        | B1+ (51–58) |

# Speaking

| CLB Competency Area        | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                          | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                                                                          | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others | Participate in routine social conversations for some everyday purposes (such as apologies, excuses, expressing opinions, and making suggestions or arrangements). | Can make an apology with brief excuses or reasons.                                                                                                                              | 45        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can enter unprepared into conversation on familiar topics (e.g. family, hobbies, work).                                                                                         | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can express attitudes using simple language.                                                                                                                                    | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can begin to use a repertoire of common idiomatic phrases in routine situations.                                                                                                | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can make an invitation using formal language.                                                                                                                                   | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can maintain professional etiquette in conversation using simple phrases and fixed expressions.                                                                                 | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can repeat back what is said to confirm understanding and keep a discussion on course.                                                                                          | 52        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                            | Participate in short phone calls.                                                                                                                                 | Can make simple work-related arrangements on the phone.                                                                                                                         | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can ask closed questions to check facts and details.                                                                                                                            | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can change simple work-related arrangements on the phone.                                                                                                                       | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can leave a voicemail message including key information.                                                                                                                        | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can discuss a travel-related problem (accommodation/transport) with a service agent over the phone.                                                                             | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can ask someone to clarify or elaborate what they have just said.                                                                                                               | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can carry out a work-related phone conversation using polite fixed expressions.                                                                                                 | 51        | B1+ (51–58) |
| II. Giving instructions    | Give sequential instructions and directions for everyday activities and processes.                                                                                | Can ask closed questions to check facts and details.                                                                                                                            | 46        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can give simple, clear instructions to organise an activity.                                                                                                                    | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can make a set of instructions easier to understand by uttering them slowly, a few words/signs at a time, employing verbal and non-verbal emphasis to facilitate understanding. | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
| III. Getting things done   | Give and respond to informal and somewhat formal suggestions and indirect requests.                                                                               | Can change simple work-related arrangements on the phone.                                                                                                                       | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can make simple recommendations on a work-related situation.                                                                                                                    | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can talk about risk using simple language.                                                                                                                                      | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can express opinions and react to practical suggestions of where to go, what to do, etc.                                                                                        | 51        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   | Can give simple reasons to justify a viewpoint on a familiar topic.                                                                                                             | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |

| CLB Competency Area                 | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                       | GSE Learning Objective                                                                        | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| III. Getting things done<br>(cont.) | Give and respond to informal and somewhat formal suggestions and indirect requests.<br>(cont.)                                                                                 | Can briefly give reasons and explanations for opinions, plans and actions.                    | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can express opinions and react to practical suggestions of where to go, what to do, etc.      | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can express opinions as regards possible solutions, giving brief reasons and explanations.    | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
| IV. Sharing information             | Ask for and give information in some detail; express opinions, feelings, obligation, ability and certainty one-on-one and in small group discussions or meetings.              | Can give straightforward descriptions on a variety of familiar subjects.                      | 47        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can give information in a job interview.                                                      | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can describe dreams, hopes and ambitions.                                                     | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can provide a basic description of professional goals.                                        | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can discuss everyday, practical issues when the conversation is conducted slowly and clearly. | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can make and justify a simple point of view on a work-related topic.                          | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can give a simple update on a work-related project.                                           | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can summarise the main ideas in a meeting using simple language.                              | 50        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can present a conclusion in a meeting using simple language.                                  | 50        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can report the opinions of others, using simple language.                                     | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can signal agreement in a simple negotiation using fixed expressions.                         | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can answer questions about professional experience.                                           | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can ask questions about someone's professional experience.                                    | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can use a suitable phrase to invite others into a discussion.                                 | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can compare and contrast alternatives about what to do, where to go, etc.                     | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can express limited opinions and arguments during work-related meetings.                      | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     | Give detailed presentations about sequences of events; incidents in the past, present or future; simple processes; or to describe or compare things such as people and places. | Can talk about work-related plans and intentions.                                             | 50        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can give a simple presentation on a work-related topic.                                       | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                | Can give a short, rehearsed talk or presentation on a familiar topic.                         | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |

# Reading

| CLB Competency Area            | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                   | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                               | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others     | Understand moderately complex social messages (such as those conveying announcements, cancellations of arrangements and apologies) related to a personal experience or a familiar context. | Can identify the writer's purpose in writing a short text e.g. to arrange a specific time to meet, to give specific information etc. | 47*       | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can identify the main topic and related ideas in a structured text.                                                                  | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can generally understand details of events, feelings and wishes in letters, emails and online postings.                              | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand updates in emails about actions taken to solve problems.                                                              | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
| II. Comprehending instructions | Understand moderately complex instructions and instructional texts for multistep procedures related to everyday situations, where the sequence must be inferred.                           | Can understand the relationship between a main point and an example in a structured text.                                            | 50        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can follow chronological sequence in a formal structured text.                                                                       | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
| III. Getting things done       | Locate and use 2 or 3 pieces of information from moderately complex formatted texts (such as maps, course calendars, directories or website navigation menus).                             | Can understand duties and responsibilities listed in job descriptions.                                                               | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand detailed information in work-related calendar appointments.                                                           | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can compare a resume/CV against a job posting to determine if key requirements have been met.                                        | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                | Get information from moderately complex business/service texts containing advice, requests or detailed specifications.                                                                     | Can understand responses to multiple choice questions about familiar products or services.                                           | 44        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand the main information in the agenda for a work-related meeting.                                                        | 47        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can extract relevant details in everyday letters, brochures and short official documents.                                            | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand standard documents related to the daily activities of a company or institution.                                       | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |

\* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

| CLB Competency Area           | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                           | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                        | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| IV. Comprehending information | Understand moderately complex descriptive or narrative texts on familiar topics.                                   | Can identify the topic sentence of a paragraph.                                                               | 47        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can derive the probable meaning of a few unknown words from short, familiar contexts.                         | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can scan several short, simple texts on the same topic to find specific information.                          | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can make simple inferences based on information given in a short article.                                     | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can distinguish between fact and opinion in relation to common topics.                                        | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can understand cause and effect relationships in a simple academic text, if clearly signalled.                | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can recognise the organisational structure of a paragraph in a simple academic text.                          | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               | Interpret information contained in formatted texts (such as diagrams, tables, graphs or website navigation menus). | Can identify the key points presented in graphs and charts in a simple academic text, if guided by questions. | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               | Access, locate and compare 2 or 3 pieces of information from online reference sources.                             | Can scan a simple academic text to find specific information.                                                 | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                               |                                                                                                                    | Can understand the main idea of a passage using textual clues.                                                | 50        | B1 (43-50)  |

# Writing

| CLB Competency Area         | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                   | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                                                                | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others  | Convey personal messages in short, formal, and informal correspondence for an expanding range of everyday social purposes (such as expressing congratulations, thanks, apologies, or offering assistance). | Can write descriptions of past events, activities, or personal experiences.                                                                                           | 47        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can write personal emails/letters giving some details of events, experiences and feelings.                                                                            | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can explain in writing why a meeting has been cancelled.                                                                                                              | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can write personal emails/letters giving advice.                                                                                                                      | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can write about experiences, feelings and reactions in a simple connected text.                                                                                       | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can write a formal email declining a work-related invitation.                                                                                                         | 53        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can write an email invitation to a work-related meeting, briefly addressing the reason for the meeting and what will be discussed.                                    | 53        | B1+ (51–58) |
| II. Reproducing information | Reduce short, factual oral discourse (such as live or recorded phone messages, pre-recorded public information lines, podcasts and short presentations) to notes or messages.                              | Can relay in writing specific information given in a straightforward recorded message, provided the topics concerned are familiar and the delivery is slow and clear. | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can take notes on a simple presentation or lecture aimed at a general audience.                                                                                       | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can write down a set of instructions being dictated to them.                                                                                                          | 51        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                             | Reduce a page of information to an outline or summary.                                                                                                                                                     | Can relay in writing specific, relevant information contained in straightforward informational texts on familiar subjects.                                            | 49        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can write a basic summary of a simple text using the original wording and paragraph order.                                                                            | 50        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can summarise the main message from simple diagrams (e.g. graphs, bar charts).                                                                                        | 52        | B1+ (51–58) |

| CLB Competency Area      | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                      | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                         | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| III. Getting things done | Write short business or service correspondence for routine purposes.                                                                                                          | Can write a simple email requesting work-related information, emphasising the most important points.           | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can describe general work-related experiences.                                                                 | 50        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write a short report on a work-related task or event.                                                      | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write a basic email/letter of complaint requesting action.                                                 | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write a simple summary of action points in a meeting.                                                      | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write an email giving some detail of work-related news and events.                                         | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          | Complete forms requiring detailed personal information.                                                                                                                       | Can complete a detailed form requiring travel information (e.g. visa application).                             | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write a basic letter of application with limited supporting details.                                       | 48        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can complete a form requiring educational information (e.g. applying for a course of study).                   | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
| IV. Sharing information  | Write 1 or 2 connected paragraphs to relate a familiar sequence of events, a story, a detailed description, or a comparison of people, things, routines or simple procedures. | Can write an everyday connected text using a set of short elements or facts and building them into a sequence. | 47        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can describe the sequence in a process when writing a simple text, using common discourse markers.             | 47        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write a short, simple factual description of a familiar sector or industry.                                | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can use common connectors to tell a story or describe an event in writing.                                     | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can clearly signal chronological sequence in narrative text.                                                   | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write a simple review of a film, book or TV programme using a limited range of language.                   | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write a short, simple comparison of products and services from different companies.                        | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can write a description of a real or imagined event (e.g. a recent trip).                                      | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                               | Can give someone clear, detailed directions on how to get somewhere in a letter, email, or online posting.     | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |

## Stage II – Benchmark 7

### Listening

| CLB Competency Area            | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                      | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others     | Understand moderately complex social exchanges (such as expressions of and responses to gratitude, hopes, appreciation, complaints, disappointment, satisfaction, dissatisfaction, approval and disapproval). | Can understand the main points of feedback from clients and colleagues if delivered slowly and clearly.               | 48        | B1 (43–50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can understand problem and solution relationships in informal conversation.                                           | 58        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can distinguish between different points of view in a discussion or presentation.                                     | 56        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can recognise misunderstandings without explicit prompting.                                                           | 58        | B1+ (51–58) |
| II. Comprehending instructions | Understand moderately complex directions and instructions for technical or non-technical tasks.                                                                                                               | Can follow detailed directions.                                                                                       | 53        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can understand advice and instructions for resolving a problem with a product or piece of equipment.                  | 55        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can generally follow rapid or extended speech, but may require repetition or clarification.                           | 57        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can follow classes and training courses on a range of subjects, provided the content is simple.                       | 57        | B1+ (51–58) |
| III. Getting things done       | Understand moderately complex communication intended to influence or persuade (such as requests, reminders, orders and pleas) in situations related to personal or general experiences.                       | Can recognise cause and effect relationships in a simple presentation or lecture when signalled by discourse markers. | 54        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can predict the content of a simple presentation or lecture by listening to the introductory statement.               | 55        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can extract the meaning of unknown words from context if the topic discussed is familiar.                             | 57        | B1+ (51–58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can recognise the use of persuasive language in a simple presentation or lecture.                                     | 57        | B1+ (51–58) |

# Listening

| CLB Competency Area           | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                         | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                             | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| IV. Comprehending information | Understand short group interactions, discussions and meetings on generally familiar topics.                                                                                                                      | Can recognise discourse markers that introduce supporting examples.                                                | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can extract the key details from discussions in meetings conducted in clear, standard speech.                      | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               | Understand extended descriptive or narrative monologues or presentations about personal experiences, general knowledge or familiar work-related topics, even when some information is presented out of sequence. | Can identify details that support a point of view in a simple presentation or lecture aimed at a general audience. | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can recognise that ideas in a simple presentation or lecture are similar when signalled by discourse markers.      | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can infer opinions in a simple presentation or lecture.                                                            | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can distinguish between main ideas and supporting details in a simple presentation or lecture.                     | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can recognise discourse markers that compare and contrast ideas.                                                   | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can distinguish facts from opinions in a simple, straightforward presentation or lecture.                          | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can recognise that ideas in a simple presentation or lecture contrast when signalled by stress.                    | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can recognise when a speaker uses basic rhetorical questions in conversation.                                      | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can deduce the general meaning of a passage from context in a longer, structured text.                             | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can follow most of a clearly structured presentation within their own field.                                       | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |

# Speaking

| CLB Competency Area        | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                             | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                                               | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others | Participate in less routine social conversations for many everyday purposes (such as expressing and responding to appreciation, complaints, satisfaction, dissatisfaction and hope). | Can make a complaint.                                                                                                                                | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can use a basic repertoire of conversation strategies to maintain a discussion.                                                                      | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can signal that they wish to bring a conversation to an end.                                                                                         | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can make excuses using a range of polite forms.                                                                                                      | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can respond to interruptions in a meeting using fixed expressions.                                                                                   | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can use polite questions to build rapport in work-related social situations.                                                                         | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can politely interrupt during a formal conversation, using fixed expressions                                                                         | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can use synonyms to describe or gloss an unknown word.                                                                                               | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            | Participate in routine phone calls.                                                                                                                                                  | Can explain the reasons for their phone call to a business or client.                                                                                | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can leave phone messages containing detailed information.                                                                                            | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can clarify information and check understanding on the phone.                                                                                        | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
| II. Giving instructions    | Give instructions and directions for technical and nontechnical tasks, procedures and processes.                                                                                     | Can give clear work-related instructions.                                                                                                            | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can reasonably fluently relate a straightforward narrative or description as a linear sequence of points.                                            | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can explain technical issues during an online meeting using simple language.                                                                         | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
| III. Getting things done   | Give extended warnings, suggestions, recommendations or advice.                                                                                                                      | Can express general concern about a work-related issue.                                                                                              | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can explain the main points in an idea or problem with reasonable precision.                                                                         | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can respond to ideas and suggestions in informal discussions.                                                                                        | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can express and comment on ideas and suggestions in informal discussions.                                                                            | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can decline offers politely using a range of formal and informal expressions.                                                                        | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can ask for advice on a wide range of subjects.                                                                                                      | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Can collaborate on a shared task, e.g. formulating and responding to suggestions, asking whether people agree, and proposing alternative approaches. | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |

| CLB Competency Area     | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                  | GSE Learning Objective                                                                            | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| IV. Sharing information | Give detailed information; express and qualify opinions and feelings; express reservations, approval, disapproval, possibilities and probabilities one-on-one and in small group discussions or meetings. | Can respond to opinions expressed by others.                                                      | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can express opinions and attitudes using a range of basic expressions and sentences.              | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can express general concern about a work-related issue.                                           | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can describe basic symptoms to a doctor, but with limited precision.                              | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can report factual information given by other people.                                             | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can respond to ideas and suggestions in informal discussions.                                     | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can express approval and appreciation of other people's ideas in a discussion.                    | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can give an opinion on practical problems, with support when necessary.                           | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can give brief comments on the views of others.                                                   | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can check that everyone agrees in group discussions using fixed expressions.                      | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can report the opinions of others.                                                                | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can discuss problems and solutions related to change in the workplace.                            | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can express disagreement in a manner that shows they were actively listening to the other person. | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can tell someone about a discussion or conversation in some detail.                               | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can express support in a manner that shows they were actively listening to the other person.      | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can exchange information on a wide range of topics within their field with some confidence.       | 59        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                         | Give presentations about moderately complex processes, to tell stories (including future scenarios), or to describe, compare and contrast in detail 2 events, jobs or procedures.                         | Can give an effective presentation about a familiar topic.                                        | 52        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can present findings from a research project in a simple way.                                     | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can develop an argument using common fixed expressions.                                           | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can give a short, prepared update on a work-related project.                                      | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can answer simple factual questions about a presentation they have given.                         | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can present results in a meeting or presentation using fixed expressions                          | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can explain the main points in an idea or problem with reasonable precision.                      | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can present information related to the business in an informal discussion.                        | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can use appropriate linking expressions to signal transitions within a presentation.              | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Can describe people's reactions to change.                                                        | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |

# Reading

| CLB Competency Area            | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                   | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                    | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others     | Understand moderately complex personal and public social messages (such as those conveying appreciation, complaints, hopes, satisfaction and dissatisfaction).             | Can infer meaning based on information in a text.                                                                         | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand factual details in work-related emails.                                                                    | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can identify the writers' communicative purpose in a text.                                                                | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can recognise the writer's point of view in a structured text.                                                            | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
| II. Comprehending instructions | Understand moderately complex instructions and instructional texts for multistep procedures related to familiar tasks, which may be specialized or technical.              | Can understand the main information in technical work-related documents.                                                  | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand written advice and instructions for resolving a problem with a product or piece of equipment.              | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand details of written product information (e.g. specifications).                                              | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
| III. Getting things done       | Locate and use 3 or 4 pieces of information from moderately complex formatted texts (such as course calendars, extensive directories, extensive website navigation menus). | Can understand the session details listed in a conference programme.                                                      | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can identify key details in work-related documents.                                                                       | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                | Get information from moderately complex business/service texts containing assessments, evaluations and advice.                                                             | Can extract the key details from simple informational materials (e.g. company policies).                                  | 49        | B1 (43-50)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can extract key details from a company blog or article.                                                                   | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can recognise significant points in straightforward reports and business letters.                                         | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand written explanations of skills needed for career progression.                                              | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand written feedback about what they are doing well and what they need to improve on in their job performance. | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand the details of a product or service well enough to make a purchasing decision.                             | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can extract key details from official documents and reports.                                                              | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand details of written product information (e.g. specifications).                                              | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |

| CLB Competency Area           | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                              | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                        | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| IV. Comprehending information | Understand moderately complex extended descriptions, reports and narrations on familiar topics.                                                       | Can recognise common discourse markers that convey emphasis in a simple text.                                 | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                       | Can recognise examples and their relation to the idea they support.                                           | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                       | Can guess the meaning of an unfamiliar word from context.                                                     | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                       | Can recognise significant points and arguments in straightforward newspaper articles on familiar topics.      | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                       | Can understand problem and solution relationships in a structured text.                                       | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               | Interpret information contained in moderately complex formatted texts (such as tables, graphs, diagrams and flow charts or website navigation menus). | Can understand numerical values in graphs and charts in a simple academic text.                               | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                       | Can identify the key points presented in graphs and charts in a simple academic text, if guided by questions. | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               | Access, locate and integrate information from online reference sources.                                                                               | Can compare information given in different texts and media on the same topic.                                 | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                       | Can synthesise information from two or more basic texts, if guided by questions.                              | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |

# Writing

| CLB Competency Area         | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                                         | GSE Learning Objective                                                                   | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others  | Convey personal messages in formal and informal correspondence for an expanding range of social purposes (such as expressing and responding to appreciation, complaints, disappointment, satisfaction, dissatisfaction or hope). | Can write an email/letter sending a message of sympathy.                                 | 51        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can respond to and comment on other people's personal updates on a social media website. | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a formal email accepting a work-related invitation.                            | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can post comments on the discussion board of a website.                                  | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can vary the formality of greetings in emails/letters based on intended recipients.      | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write personal updates on a social media website using an appropriate style.         | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a work-related email/letter expressing thanks in detail.                       | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write emails/letters responding to personal news and views in detail.                | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
| II. Reproducing information | Reduce short oral discourse (such as live or recorded phone messages, pre-recorded public information, podcasts or short presentations) to notes.                                                                                | Can take messages, communicate enquiries and explain problems.                           | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a simple summary of action points from a meeting.                              | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can take notes of key points during a talk on a familiar topic, if delivered clearly.    | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write notes when someone is describing a problem.                                    | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             | Reduce a text of up to about 2 pages to an outline or summary.                                                                                                                                                                   | Can take notes while researching a familiar topic.                                       | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a simple project plan with key deliverables.                                   | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can collate short pieces of information and summarise them for somebody else.            | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |

| CLB Competency Area      | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                         | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                         | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| III. Getting things done | Write business or service correspondence for a range of routine and less routine purposes (such as passing on information, and making and responding to requests, recommendations and warnings). | Can write emails/letters exchanging information, emphasising the most important point.                         | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a short, simple work-related report outlining key issues.                                            | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a formal email/letter requesting information.                                                        | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can make suggestions and recommendations on work-related topics.                                               | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a short, simple marketing document, describing products or services.                                 | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write an email, giving details of work-related events, facts, or plans.                                    | 57        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a description of a problem with a product or piece of equipment.                                     | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write comments and complaints about products and services.                                                 | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          | Complete extended forms requiring detailed personal information.                                                                                                                                 | Can complete a form requiring health information.                                                              | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can complete a form requiring financial information (e.g. application for a bank account or credit agreement). | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
| IV. Sharing information  | Write 2 or 3 connected paragraphs to relate a familiar sequence of events, make a comparison, or provide a detailed description of a person, system, routine or procedure.                       | Can write simple structured essays, organising basic ideas.                                                    | 53        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can check and correct spelling, punctuation and grammar in simple written texts.                               | 54        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can show a simple relationship between a main point and an example in a structured text.                       | 55        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write instructions on how to use a device or product.                                                      | 56        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Can write a business report using a standard template.                                                         | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |

## Stage II – Benchmark 8

### Listening

| CLB Competency Area            | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others     | Understand moderately complex social exchanges (such as expressions of and responses to gratitude, hopes, appreciation, complaints, disappointment, satisfaction, dissatisfaction, approval, disapproval, formal welcomes and farewells, condolences and congratulations). | Can identify the main reasons for and against an argument or idea in a discussion delivered in clear standard speech. | 59        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand in detail work-related phone messages.                                                                 | 61        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can recognise emphasis through intonation and stress.                                                                 | 61        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand main points and check comprehension by using contextual clues.                                         | 64        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand the speaker's point of view on most topics delivered at natural speed and in standard language.        | 65        | B2 (59–66)  |
| II. Comprehending instructions | Understand extended multistep directions or instructions for technical or non-technical tasks.                                                                                                                                                                             | Can follow the stages of a complex process described using non-technical language.                                    | 61        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand detailed instructions well enough to be able to follow them without making mistakes.                   | 62        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can follow chronological sequences in extended informal speech at natural speed.                                      | 65        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand the main ideas of complex technical discussions in their field.                                        | 66        | B2 (59–66)  |
| III. Getting things done       | Understand communication intended to influence or persuade (such as extended warnings, threats, suggestions, recommendations and proposed solutions) in situations related to personal decisions or to work-related issues in own field.                                   | Can recognise inferred meaning in a simple presentation or lecture.                                                   | 59        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can critically evaluate the main points of a straightforward presentation or lecture.                                 | 61        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can recognise that a speaker is expressing concerns in a formal discussion.                                           | 60        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand the advantages and disadvantages of different options during a discussion.                             | 64        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand main points and check comprehension by using contextual clues.                                         | 64        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Can understand a course of action suggested during a negotiation.                                                     | 67        | B2+ (67–75) |

# Listening

| CLB Competency Area           | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                               | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                       | GSE level | CEFR level |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|
| IV. Comprehending information | Understand group interactions about abstract and complex ideas on familiar topics.                                                                                     | Can identify the main reasons for and against an argument or idea in a discussion delivered in clear standard speech.        | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can recognise generalisations and their supporting ideas.                                                                    | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can follow a natural group discussion, but may find it difficult to participate effectively.                                 | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can distinguish between fact and opinion in informal discussion at natural speed.                                            | 66        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               | Understand extended monologues or presentations on topics that are generally familiar and related to general knowledge or technical/ work-related issues in own field. | Can recognise the basic organisational structure of different types of presentations.                                        | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can distinguish between relevant and irrelevant content in extended informal speech.                                         | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can recognise paraphrasing and repetition in a straightforward presentation or lecture.                                      | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can follow the stages of a complex process described using non-technical language.                                           | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can critically evaluate the effectiveness of slides or other visual materials that accompany a simple presentation.          | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can recognise the speaker's point of view in a structured presentation.                                                      | 63        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can interpret the purpose of content of visuals (e.g. diagrams, charts) used to support an academic lecture or presentation. | 63        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can understand specialised vocabulary used in presentations or discussions within their field.                               | 66        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can follow chronological sequences in extended informal speech at natural speed.                                             | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can understand cause and effect relationships in informal conversation at natural speed.                                     | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                        | Can extract the main points from news items, etc. with opinions, arguments and discussion.                                   | 65        | B2 (59–66) |

# Speaking

| CLB Competency Area        | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                     | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                  | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others | Participate in less routine social conversations for most everyday purposes (such as expressing and responding to empathy, clarifying conflicts, and providing reassurance). | Can respond to conflict in a simple negotiation using fixed expressions.                                                | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can discuss details of a work-related task (e.g. deadlines, specifications).                                            | 59        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can pass on a detailed piece of information reliably.                                                                   | 60        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can engage in extended conversation in a clearly participatory fashion on most general topics.                          | 61        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can express feelings (e.g. sympathy, surprise, interest) with confidence, using a range of expressions.                 | 61        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can make a formal apology with detailed excuses or reasons.                                                             | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can use a range of language to express degrees of enthusiasm.                                                           | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can encourage discussion by inviting others to join in, say what they think, etc.                                       | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can adjust their tone of voice to express empathy when delivering bad news to a colleague or client.                    | 63        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can contribute to a conversation fluently and naturally, provided the topic is not too abstract or complex.             | 66        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            | Participate in brief professional phone calls.                                                                                                                               | Can repeat back what is said during a teleconference to confirm understanding.                                          | 59        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can invite others into the discussion during a teleconference by asking for questions.                                  | 60        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can end an extended professional phone conversation, summarising content and conclusions.                               | 70        | B2+ (67-75) |
| II. Giving instructions    | Give instructions and directions for a broad range of technical and non-technical tasks, procedures and processes.                                                           | Can describe how to do something, giving detailed instructions.                                                         | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can give a clear, detailed spoken description of how to carry out a procedure.                                          | 63        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can give clear instructions about solving job-related problems.                                                         | 64        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                              | Can explain the different roles of participants in the collaborative process, giving clear instructions for group work. | 65        | B2 (59-66)  |

| CLB Competency Area                | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                           | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                    | GSE level | CEFR level |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|
| II. Giving instructions<br>(cont.) | Propose or recommend solutions to problems in a familiar area.                                                                                                                                                     | Can politely express dissatisfaction for products and services offered by a company or institution.                       | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can express specific concerns about a work-related issue.                                                                 | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can suggest solutions to problems and explain why they would work.                                                        | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can describe an everyday consumer-related problem and request a correction or solution.                                   | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can discuss possible options for dealing with a work-related task.                                                        | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can ask questions to stimulate discussion on how to organise collaborative work.                                          | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can answer complaints from dissatisfied employees and customers politely.                                                 | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can explain a problem and demand what action should be taken in an appropriate way.                                       | 64        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can deal with dissatisfied clients or customers politely.                                                                 | 64        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can give advice on a wide range of subjects.                                                                              | 66        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can outline an issue or problem clearly.                                                                                  | 66        | B2 (59–66) |
| IV. Sharing information            | Give detailed information; express and qualify opinions or concerns; present solutions and options; indicate opposition or support for a stand in one-on-one interactions and small group discussions or meetings. | Can take part in routine formal discussions conducted in clear standard speech in which factual information is exchanged. | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can discuss a plan of action for dealing with a work-related task.                                                        | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can encourage agreement in meetings using fixed expressions.                                                              | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can describe the degree of necessity of various actions.                                                                  | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can encourage decision-making in meetings using fixed expressions.                                                        | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can recommend a course of action, giving reasons.                                                                         | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can make a factual comparison of products and services from different companies.                                          | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can develop an argument giving reasons in support of or against a particular point of view.                               | 63        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can express views clearly and evaluate hypothetical proposals in informal discussions.                                    | 64        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can use stock phrases to gain time and keep the turn whilst formulating what to say.                                      | 64        | B2 (59–66) |

## Speaking

| CLB Competency Area                | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                                      | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                        | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| IV. Sharing information<br>(cont.) | Give detailed information; express and qualify opinions or concerns; present solutions and options; indicate opposition or support for a stand in one-on-one interactions and small group discussions or meetings.<br>(cont.) | Can use a range of language to express degrees of reluctance.                                                 | 65        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can express opinions about news stories using a wide range of everyday language.                              | 65        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can use intonation to indicate various degrees of certainty during a discussion.                              | 65        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can manage discussion on familiar topics confirming comprehension, inviting others in, etc.                   | 65        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can give feedback to an employee about what they are doing well and what they need to improve on.             | 65        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can discuss specific comments made on a performance evaluation form.                                          | 65        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can introduce new information during a formal discussion or presentation                                      | 66        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can develop an argument well enough to be followed without difficulty most of the time.                       | 66        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can give detailed feedback about someone's performance on a familiar task or project.                         | 67        | B2+ (67–75) |
|                                    | Give presentations to describe and explain structures, systems or processes based on research.                                                                                                                                | Can respond to clearly expressed questions on a presentation they have given.                                 | 61        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can justify the reasons for a particular decision or course of action.                                        | 62        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can construct a chain of reasoned argument.                                                                   | 62        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can recommend particular actions at the end of a presentation.                                                | 63        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can compare and contrast situations in some detail and speculate about the reasons for the current situation. | 64        | B2 (59–66)  |
|                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Can develop a clear argument with supporting subsidiary points and relevant examples.                         | 66        | B2 (59–66)  |

# Reading

| CLB Competency Area            | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                        | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                      | GSE level | CEFR level  |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| I. Interacting with others     | Understand moderately complex social messages (such as those conveying general opinions, assessments of current events or situations, and responses to complaints or sympathy). | Can understand most correspondence relating to their field of interest.                                                     | 58        | B1+ (51-58) |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can understand the author's purpose and intended audience.                                                                  | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can distinguish between ambiguity and certainty in emails/letters.                                                          | 63        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can recognise the tone and intended audience of a structured text.                                                          | 65        | B2 (59-66)  |
| II. Comprehending instructions | Understand extended, moderately complex, multistep instructions and instructional texts for established (set) procedures related to specialized tasks.                          | Can understand instructions for making financial transactions online.                                                       | 59        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can understand the rules and expected behaviours described in a company's code of conduct document.                         | 61        | B2 (59-66)  |
| III. Getting things done       | Locate, integrate and use 3 or 4 pieces of information from moderately complex formatted texts.                                                                                 | Can recognise the use of cohesive devices to link ideas within and between paragraphs in a written text.                    | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can interpret the main message from complex diagrams and visual information.                                                | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                | Get information from moderately complex business/service texts containing proposals, recommendations and statements of rules, regulations or policies.                          | Can infer the meaning of words from context in work-related documents or publications on unfamiliar topics.                 | 64        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can understand in detail the agenda for a work-related meeting.                                                             | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can extract key details from an article on a business-related topic.                                                        | 63        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can scan a long text or a set of related texts in order to find specific information.                                       | 63        | B2 (59-66)  |
| IV. Comprehending information  | Understand moderately complex extended descriptions, feature articles, reports and narrations.                                                                                  | Can infer the meaning of words from context in work-related documents on familiar topics.                                   | 59        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can identify language used to persuade the reader.                                                                          | 60        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can distinguish between facts and opinions in structured meeting notes.                                                     | 60        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can make inferences or predictions about the content of newspaper and magazine articles from headings, titles or headlines. | 60        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can distinguish supporting details from the main points in a text.                                                          | 61        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can understand the plot of extended narratives written in standard, non-literary language.                                  | 62        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can make inferences about the attitudes and feelings of characters based on evidence in the text.                           | 63        | B2 (59-66)  |
|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Can summarise, comment on and discuss a wide range of factual and imaginative texts.                                        | 66        | B2 (59-66)  |

Reading

| CLB Competency Area                      | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                               | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                           | GSE level | CEFR level |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|
| IV. Comprehending information<br>(cont.) | Interpret information contained in moderately complex formatted texts (such as tables, graphs, diagrams and website navigation menus). | Can follow the exchanges on the discussion board of a website.                                                                   | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                          |                                                                                                                                        | Can interpret the main message from complex diagrams and visual information.                                                     | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                          |                                                                                                                                        | Can understand the use of numerical data in graphs and charts in a linguistically complex academic text, if guided by questions. | 63        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                          | Access, locate and integrate several pieces of information from relevant online reference sources.                                     | Can use a monolingual dictionary to check the meaning of words without needing to refer to a bilingual dictionary.               | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                          |                                                                                                                                        | Can use reference materials to check factual information, when guidance on finding relevant sources of information is provided.  | 63        | B2 (59–66) |

| CLB Competency Area         | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                               | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                                                            | GSE level | CEFR level |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|
| I. Interacting with others  | Convey personal messages in formal and informal correspondence for an expanded range of social purposes (such as expressing and responding to sympathy, clarifying a conflict, or giving reassurance). | Can write a formal email/letter of thanks or apology with appropriate conventions.                                                                                | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can write personal emails/letters giving and commenting on news in detail.                                                                                        | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can respond effectively to emails requesting work-related information.                                                                                            | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can politely reply in writing to emails/letters of complaint.                                                                                                     | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can write a formal email/letter of invitation with appropriate register and conventions.                                                                          | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can write personal emails/letters giving and commenting on news in detail.                                                                                        | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can give advice, including reasons.                                                                                                                               | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can politely disagree with a suggestion or recommendation made in email.                                                                                          | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can write a formal email/letter of apology using appropriate conventions.                                                                                         | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can recognise misunderstandings and disagreements that arise in an online interaction and deal with them, provided the interlocutor(s) are willing to co-operate. | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can write personal emails/letters about abstract or cultural topics (e.g. music, films).                                                                          | 64        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can express news and views effectively in writing and relate to those of others.                                                                                  | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can adopt a level of formality appropriate to the circumstances.                                                                                                  | 66        | B2 (59–66) |
| II. Reproducing information | Reduce oral discourse about established procedures (given in a live demonstration, over the phone, or from pre-recorded audio or video material) into notes that can be used to write instructions.    | Can take notes to record the main points raised during meetings on familiar topics.                                                                               | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can record the details of project-related actions and results in a log.                                                                                           | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can take notes on a presentation or lecture in their field of specialisation.                                                                                     | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can summarise information from a presentation or lecture in their field of specialisation.                                                                        | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can write a summary of the decisions and action items identified during a meeting.                                                                                | 66        | B2 (59–66) |
|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Can take accurate notes in meetings and seminars on most matters likely to arise within their field of interest.                                                  | 66        | B2 (59–66) |

## Writing

| CLB Competency Area                    | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                                            | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                         | GSE level | CEFR level |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|
| II. Reproducing information<br>(cont.) | Reduce a text of up to about 2 pages to an outline or summary.                                                                                                                                                      | Can summarise in writing the main content of complex texts on subjects related to their fields of interest and specialisation. | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can summarise in writing different points of view.                                                                             | 64        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can edit notes or bullet points to make them more concise.                                                                     | 64        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can write a concise summary of the main ideas of a longer structured text.                                                     | 64        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can relay in writing the significant point(s) contained in formal correspondence.                                              | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can write bullet points to summarise key points in an academic text.                                                           | 66        | B2 (59–66) |
| III. Getting things done               | Write business or service correspondence for an expanding range of purposes (such as giving information in memoranda, documenting work done, indicating a problem, requesting a change, or requesting information). | Can write a detailed description of an object, device or product.                                                              | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can organise a work-related email to emphasise the main point.                                                                 | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can demonstrate understanding of formality and conventions in standard letters.                                                | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can write a brief standard report conveying factual information, stating reasons for actions.                                  | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can write instructions on how to repair an object, device or product.                                                          | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can clearly signal problem and solution relationships in structured text.                                                      | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can write a formal letter of complaint about a product or service.                                                             | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can use appropriate register in work-related written communication.                                                            | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can write a short, concise report explaining how a product meets a specific need.                                              | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can respond to work-related emails, clearly addressing the sender's points and arguments.                                      | 63        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can write clear, detailed instructions about how to complete a familiar work-related task or project.                          | 64        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can give a structured written explanation of a problem.                                                                        | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can write a letter of complaint with appropriate register, structure and conventions.                                          | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Can make written requests for updates on actions taken to solve problems.                                                      | 65        | B2 (59–66) |

| CLB Competency Area                 | CLB Competency Statement                                                                                                                                                                           | GSE Learning Objective                                                                                                                    | GSE level | CEFR level |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|
| III. Getting things done<br>(cont.) | Complete an expanded range of forms, including extended application forms and workplace forms with pre-set formats.                                                                                | Can write a covering letter addressing specific information mentioned in a job posting.                                                   | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can write a letter of application with appropriate register, conventions and supporting detail.                                           | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
| IV. Sharing information             | Write 3 or 4 connected paragraphs to relate a historical event, provide a detailed description of a phenomenon, explain a procedure, or express and analyze opinions on a familiar abstract topic. | Can support ideas with relevant examples.                                                                                                 | 59        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can clearly signal cause and effect relationships in a structured text.                                                                   | 60        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can compare information from different sources.                                                                                           | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can end a discursive argument with a clear conclusion and opinion.                                                                        | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can present additional ideas using a range of linking words and phrases.                                                                  | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can structure longer texts in clear, logical paragraphs.                                                                                  | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can systematically evaluate the advantages and disadvantages of various options.                                                          | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can compare and evaluate ideas in a structured and logical text.                                                                          | 66        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     | Write a paragraph to explain information in a table, graph, flow chart or diagram.                                                                                                                 | Can contrast two ideas when writing a simple academic text by using discourse markers.                                                    | 61        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can write a short analysis of a business trend in their own professional field.                                                           | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can use statistical data, fractions, and percentages in an academic text.                                                                 | 62        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can write a structured paragraph on an academic topic in their field of study.                                                            | 65        | B2 (59–66) |
|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Can interpret and present reliably in writing detailed information from diagrams and visually organised data in their fields of interest. | 66        | B2 (59–66) |

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